

Subject Code	AF5202
Subject Title	Contemporary Issues in Attestation and Assurance Services
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Normal Duration	One Semester
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This subject contributes to the achievement of the MSc in Accountancy Programme Outcomes by enabling students <u>to use the conceptual frameworks needed to evaluate contemporary issues in attestation and assurance services</u>. Students will be able to <u>understand basic econometrics methods applied to auditing and accounting research work</u> by enabling students to better understand how different auditing and accounting issues can be addressed, and obtain methodological perspectives from assessing the myriad of choices of methods that researchers make. Additionally, the subject will help students to <u>apply appropriate conceptual frameworks in more specialized areas of auditing and accounting</u> by relating together theoretical and practical aspects of what they have learnt and considered during the course. Furthermore, this course will enhance students' communication and collaboration skills, facilitating their adaptability and resilience in lifelong learning journey. (Programme Outcome 3).
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: <u>Use</u> conceptual frameworks in evaluating contemporary issues in auditing, corporate governance and accounting. <u>Evaluate</u> contemporary issues in auditing, corporate governance and accounting research. <u>Evaluate</u> methodological perspectives / choices made by researchers. <u>Apply</u> research skills developed during the course to assist in choosing auditing, corporate governance or accounting topics of interest to research. <u>Comprehend</u> research results, including regression results, used in research papers. <u>Undertake</u> a research assignment (individual) that will strengthen their knowledge base in chosen topic area.

[illegible]

	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Class participation – Students are required to actively participate in in-class activities and discussions of topics and issues covered in the course. Assignment – A research topic relating to contemporary issues in auditing, accounting or corporate governance chosen by the student and acceptable to the lecturer where the student researches this topic drawing from contemporary literature to gain a deeper understanding of the topic area, and to gain an understanding of the choices, and difficulties that researchers face. Presentations – A number of group presentations of topical research papers which requires a good understanding of these papers. Final examination – 3 hours examination of potentially all topics covered in the course including contemporary issues and related research, general understanding of findings, and interpretation of results achieved by researchers. <i>Note: The specific requirements on individual assessment components discussed above could be adjusted based on the pedagogical needs of subject lecturers</i>	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures / Seminars	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Depends on their backgrounds, on average students are expected to spend around 2 more hours for each contact hour for reading subject materials, including research papers for presentations and assignment.	78 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	117 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Important research papers and articles selected by the lecturer.	